

Champion of the Board

Because he is world champion and one-man revolution all rolled into one, and is India's highest-paid sportsperson, with the appearance fees rumoured to be \$250,000 depending on who wants him to play.

Becausehe is the face of the NIFT Mind Champions Academy that has taken chess e-learning in schools from 1,605 clubs in 2003 to 6,551 clubs and 7.4 lakh members in 2008.

power move Winning his third world chess championship in Germany.

little known fact His passion for rock music—from the Rolling Stones to U2.

VISWANATHAN
ANAND

47

38, Chess Grandmaster New



YASBANT NEGI

NARENDRA BISHT



N.K.
SINGH

49

68, MP New

Medicine Man

Because he has taken to heart the provision of affordable health care by creating large health cities in seven cities.

Becausehe conceptualised the world's cheapest health insurance programme, Yeshaswini Micro Health Insurance, that covers three million beneficiaries in Karnataka alone, at Rs 5 a month each.

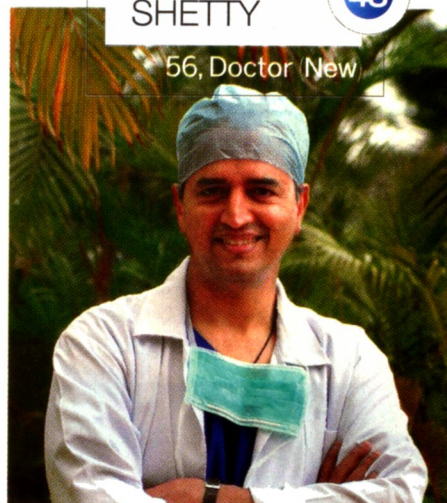
big fight Practices a martial art known as Budokan Karate.

big number He has performed more than 10,000 heart operations with one of the highest success rates worldwide.

DEVI
SHETTY

48

56, Doctor New



GIREESH GV

The Sophisticate

Becausehe is much sought after for his eclectic intellect and has the ability to bring together at dinner, whether at his Vasant Vihar home or at Davos, billionaires, international leaders, think-tank types and multi-lateral agency chiefs.

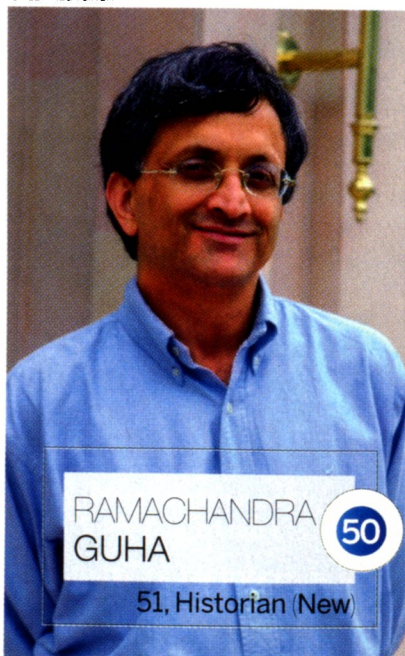
Becausethis was the year he was finally elected to the Rajya Sabha, thanks to Nitish Kumar.

cool buddies George Yeo to Nicholas Stern, L.N. Mittal to Mukesh Ambani, Sunil Mittal to Anand Mahindra.

pet project Preparing a blueprint for the revival of Nalanda University.

his music Listening to Kishori Ambonkar on his Bang & Olufsen system.

SJWEEET INDER SINGH



RAMACHANDRA
GUHA

50

51, Historian (New)

The Write Stuff

Becausehe is one of the few independent intellectuals in India, rated 44 in a list of the 100 most influential intellectuals worldwide last year by *Foreign Policy* magazine.

Becausehe makes academics look cool, writing with as much ease on Verrier Elwin as on cricket.

Becausehe's not afraid of taking an unpopular stand—even if it is urging Arundhati Roy to stick to writing for backing the Narmada Bachao Andolan.

writing style Disciplined. Every day from 9 a.m. to 1.30 p.m.

next move A prequel to *India After Gandhi* about the first half of the 20th century.